

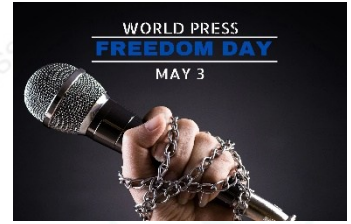
## WEEKLY CA – 2<sup>nd</sup> May – 8<sup>th</sup> May

1. The Declaration of Windhoek is associated with which of the following days?

विंडहोक घोषणा निम्नलिखित में से किस दिवस से संबंधित है?

- A. World Human Rights Day
- B. World Press Freedom Day
- C. International Day of Peace
- D. World Environment Day

Answer: B



### 3 May World Press Freedom Day

- Celebrates the fundamental principles of press freedom
- World Press Freedom Day was proclaimed by the UN General Assembly in 1993
- **Theme:** Shaping a Future at Peace
- 3 May, the anniversary of the Declaration of Windhoek is celebrated worldwide as World Press Freedom Day.
- **The Windhoek Declaration was established during a UNESCO seminar held in Windhoek, Namibia, from April 29 to May 3, 1991.**

| Date                                   | Day                                     | Theme                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2 <sup>nd</sup> May                    | World Tuna Day                          |                                                                                        |
| 3 <sup>rd</sup> May                    | International Sun Day                   |                                                                                        |
| 4 <sup>th</sup> May                    | Coal Miners Day                         |                                                                                        |
| 4 <sup>th</sup> May                    | International Firefighter's Day         |                                                                                        |
| 4 <sup>th</sup> – 10 <sup>th</sup> May | Fire Safety Week                        |                                                                                        |
| 5 <sup>th</sup> May                    | World Asthma Day (First Tuesday of May) | "Access to anti-inflammatory inhalers for everyone with asthma – still an urgent need" |
| 7 <sup>th</sup> May                    | World Athletics Day                     |                                                                                        |
| 8 <sup>th</sup> May                    | World Red Cross and Red Crescent Day    | United in humanity.                                                                    |
| 8 <sup>th</sup> May                    | World Thalassaemia Day                  | "Hidden No More: Finding the Undiagnosed. Supporting the Unseen."                      |

2. Who has been appointed as the Chairman of the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC)?

केंद्रीय फिल्म प्रमाणन बोर्ड (CBFC) के अध्यक्ष के रूप में किसे नियुक्त किया गया है?

- A. Prasoon Joshi
- B. Shashi Shekhar Vempati
- C. Anurag Thakur
- D. Amit Khare

Answer: B



### Former Prasar Bharati CEO Shashi Shekhar Vempati appointed CBFC Chairman

- The Ministry of Information and Broadcasting appointed former Prasar Bharati CEO Shashi Shekhar Vempati as the Chairman of the **Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC)**.
- Mr. Vempati's appointment as the Chairperson of the CBFC comes days after Prasoon Joshi's appointment as the Chairman of Prasar Bharati.
- An, **alumnus of IIT-Bombay, Mr. Vempati was the CEO of Prasar Bharati from 2017 to 2022.**
- **He was the youngest and first non-bureaucrat to hold the public office since its creation in 1997.** He also held additional charge as CEO of Rajya Sabha from August 2017 to May 2019.

### 3. J. Craig Venter is best known for:

जे. क्रेग वेंटर मुख्य रूप से इसके लिए जाने जाते हैं:

- Discovery of DNA double helix structure
- Mapping the first draft of the human genome
- Development of CRISPR gene editing
- Cloning of Dolly the sheep

Answer: (b)



### J. Craig Venter, who won the race to sequence the human genome, dies at 79

- J. Craig Venter, who mapped the first draft of the human genome and helped scientists understand how genes shape our lives, died. He was 79.
- **The J. Craig Venter Institute, a genomics research group with locations in La Jolla, California, and Rockville, Maryland**

### 4. The 2026 UNESCO/Guillermo Cano World Press Freedom Prize was awarded to:

2026 का UNESCO/Guillermo Cano विश्व प्रेस स्वतंत्रता पुरस्कार किसे प्रदान किया गया?

- Reporters Without Borders
- Sudanese Journalists Syndicate
- Committee to Protect Journalists
- International Federation of Journalists

Answer: B



### Guillermo Cano World Press Freedom Prize 2026

- **UNESCO has awarded the 2026 UNESCO/Guillermo Cano World Press Freedom Prize to the Sudanese Journalists Syndicate.**
- The UNESCO/Guillermo Cano World Press Freedom Prize is the only UN-recognized award honoring individuals or organizations defending press freedom under difficult conditions.
- **Established In: 1997**

#### Aim:

- To recognize outstanding contributions to the defence and promotion of press freedom globally.
- To honour journalists who demonstrate courage in the face of threats, violence, or repression.

#### Key Features:

- **Global Recognition:** Awarded annually to journalists/organizations worldwide for exceptional commitment to press freedom.
- **Independent Jury:** Laureate selected by an international panel of media professionals.
- **Symbolic Legacy:** Named after Guillermo Cano Isaza, assassinated for his fearless journalism.

### 5. Who has been appointed as the President of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT)?

राष्ट्रीय कंपनी कानून न्यायाधिकरण (NCLT) के अध्यक्ष के रूप में किसे नियुक्त किया गया है?

- A. Anupinder Singh Grewal  
B. Ramalingam Sudhakar  
C. D. Y. Chandrachud  
D. N. V. Ramana

Answer: A

### Justice Grewal Appointed NCLT President by Centre

- Justice (retired) Anupinder Singh Grewal, a former judge of the Punjab and Haryana High Court, has been appointed President of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT).
- He will hold office for five years from the date he assumes charge or until he attains the age of 67, whichever is earlier.
- Justice Grewal succeeds Justice (retired) Ramalingam Sudhakar**, former Chief Justice of the Manipur High Court, who demitted office earlier this year.

### About NCLT

- Constitution:** A quasi-judicial body established under the Companies Act, 2013.
- Role:** Adjudicates disputes related to companies and corporate governance.
- Insolvency authority:** Functions as the adjudicating authority under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016.

### Objectives:

- To club every matter related to Companies under one roof.
- To deal with the matters related to sick and distressed industries.

### 6. The apnoea test is primarily used to determine:

एपनिया टेस्ट का उपयोग मुख्य रूप से यह निर्धारित करने के लिए किया जाता है:

- A. Cardiac arrest  
B. Lung infection  
C. Kidney failure  
D. Brain death

Answer: D

### The Apnoea Test

- The Supreme Court of India has agreed to examine a **medical plea alleging that the apnoea test, used as a primary assessment for brain death in Kerala, may be medically inconclusive and potentially dangerous.**
- The apnoea test is a mandatory clinical procedure **used to determine if a patient is brain-dead** (death by neurologic criteria).
- It **specifically checks if the brainstem—the part of the brain that controls automatic functions like breathing—is still functioning.**

### Aim:

- The primary goal is to see if the body can trigger a breath on its own when carbon dioxide (CO<sub>2</sub>) levels in the blood rise to a specific high point.
- If the patient does not attempt to breathe even when CO<sub>2</sub> is very high, it indicates that the brainstem has permanently lost its function.

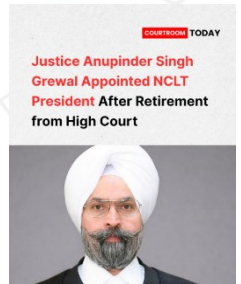
### 7. Which organisation launched the Central Prabhar Officer (CPO) Portal?

किस संगठन ने केंद्रीय प्रभारी अधिकारी (CPO) पोर्टल लॉन्च किया?

- A. Ministry of Home Affairs  
B. NITI Aayog  
C. Ministry of Rural Development  
D. Digital India Corporation

Answer: B

NITI Aayog Launches Central Prabhar Officer (CPO) Portal to Strengthen Real-Time Governance and Last-Mile Delivery



### SC to examine plea against apnoea test for brain death

Petitioner claims apnoea test may by itself induce brain death as it requires stopping or reducing cerebral blood flow; court asks AIMS to form expert team, submit recommendations in 2 months

**The Hindu Bureau**  
New Delhi

The Supreme Court has agreed to examine a medical plea alleging that the apnoea test, used as a primary assessment for brain death in Kerala, may be medically inconclusive and potentially dangerous.

A bench of Justices Varun G. and Sanjay K. recorded the constitution of a committee, a medical professional, that the apnoea test may by itself induce brain death as it requires stopping or reducing cerebral blood flow. The court asked AIMS to form an expert team, submit recommendations in 2 months.

The petitioner alleged that the test involved inducing death, as it required stopping or reducing cerebral blood flow. The petitioner also claimed that the test was not a conclusive assessment of brain death, as it required stopping or reducing cerebral blood flow. The petitioner also claimed that the test was not a conclusive assessment of brain death, as it required stopping or reducing cerebral blood flow.

The court has directed the State to form an expert team, submit recommendations in 2 months. The court has also directed the State to form an expert team, submit recommendations in 2 months.



- NITI Aayog launched the Central Prabhar Officer (CPO) Portal, which is aimed at strengthening real-time governance, improving coordination among stakeholders and accelerating last-mile delivery under the Aspirational Districts and Blocks Programme (ADP/ABP).
- The portal was formally launched by Ms. Nidhi Chhibber, CEO, NITI Aayog.
- The platform enables real-time submission and tracking of field observations, ensuring that insights from the ground directly inform policy actions and administrative interventions.
- CPO Portal is designed as an advanced digital platform to capture real-time observations, streamline communication and enable faster administrative response across all levels of governance.

8. The Integrated Alert System (SACHET) has been developed by:

एकीकृत अलर्ट प्रणाली (SACHET) को किसके द्वारा विकसित किया गया है?

- A. Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- B. Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
- C. Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT)
- D. National Informatics Centre (NIC)

Answer: C

#### India launched C-DoT cell broadcasting system for nationwide disaster alerts

- Mobile phones across the country went abuzz after Union Telecom Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia launched the cell broadcast alert system on Saturday that will warn citizens about emergency and natural disasters in their area.
- The Department of Telecom had already alerted citizens about the trial run of the service on April 29 to avoid panic, with an appeal to ignore any alerts they receive.

#### What is a cell broadcast test?

- In contrast to standard text messages, cell broadcasts can reach all mobile phones within a designated geographical area, providing extensive and rapid coverage without putting excessive strain on telecom networks.
- This system has been particularly used by government agencies to deliver warnings and important updates to the public.
- To enhance the effectiveness of alert distribution in urgent situations—such as tsunamis, earthquakes, lightning strikes, and human-made emergencies like gas leaks or chemical hazards—Cell Broadcast (CB) technology has been implemented alongside SMS.
- What is NDMA test cell broadcast?
- It is a test message sent by the NDMA in collaboration with the Department of Telecommunications (DoT), Government of India.
- NDMA has successfully operationalised the Integrated Alert System (SACHET), created by the Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT), which is the leading research and development centre under the Department of Telecommunications.
- The system is based on the Common Alerting Protocol (CAP) as recommended by the UN body International Telecommunication Union.
- It is currently operational across all 36 States and Union Territories of India and delivers disaster and emergency-related alerts via SMS to mobile users within geo-targeted areas.

9. India's first portable bedside MRI system has been introduced by:

भारत का पहला पोर्टेबल बेडसाइड MRI सिस्टम किसके द्वारा पेश किया गया है?

- A. PGIMER Chandigarh
- B. AIIMS New Delhi
- C. NIMHANS Bengaluru
- D. Tata Memorial Hospital

Answer: B

### India's First Portable MRI System Deployed at AIIMS Delhi for ICU Patients

- In a first, AIIMS New Delhi has introduced India's first portable bedside MRI system.
- The ultra-low-field device can be wheeled directly to a patient's bedside, enabling rapid brain imaging for critically ill patients in ICUs, emergency settings, and neurosurgical care.
- Unlike conventional MRI machines that require dedicated suites and patient transport, this system eliminates the risks associated with moving unstable patients and allows imaging to be performed within the safety of the ICU environment.
- Across the world, portable bedside MRI systems are being used in hospitals in the US, Canada, Australia, the UK, New Zealand, and various EU countries.



### DAMPE Satellite

- China's DAMPE space telescope recently made an observation on the acceleration of cosmic rays, such as nuclei of hydrogen, helium, etc., and found that the intensity of the cosmic radiation decreases more rapidly upon reaching a specific high-energy threshold.
- DAMPE (Dark Matter Particle Explorer), also known as "Wukong", is China's first astronomical satellite.
- The satellite was launched into a polar, sun-synchronous orbit with an altitude of 500 km on December 17, 2015.
- The main scientific objective of DAMPE is to measure electrons and photons with much higher energy resolution and energy reach than achievable with existing space experiments in order to identify possible dark matter signatures.

### 10. Consider the following statements regarding DAMPE:

1. It is China's first astronomical satellite.
2. It is designed to detect high-energy cosmic rays and gamma rays.
3. It operates in a geostationary orbit.

### Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only  
(b) 2 and 3 only  
(c) 1 and 3 only  
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

### DAMPE Satellite

- **China's DAMPE space telescope recently made an observation on the acceleration of cosmic rays, such as nuclei of hydrogen, helium, etc., and found that the intensity of the cosmic radiation decreases more rapidly upon reaching a specific high-energy threshold.**
- **DAMPE (Dark Matter Particle Explorer), also known as "Wukong", is China's first astronomical satellite.**
- **The satellite was launched into a polar, sun-synchronous orbit with an altitude of 500 km on December 17, 2015.**
- The main scientific objective of DAMPE is to measure electrons and photons with much higher energy resolution and energy reach than achievable with existing space experiments in order to identify possible dark matter signatures.

### 11. The Pulitzer Prize 2026 for Investigative Reporting was awarded to:

जांच-पड़ताल वाली रिपोर्टिंग के लिए 2026 का पुलित्ज़र पुरस्कार किसे दिया गया?

- (a) Staff of Reuters  
(b) Staff of The New York Times  
(c) Staff of Bloomberg  
(d) Staff of The Washington Post



Answer: (b)

### Anand RK, Suparna Sharma Win 2026 Pulitzer Prize

- Indian journalists R.K. Anand and Suparna Sharma have won the prestigious Pulitzer Prize for their work highlighting digital surveillance and cyber fraud.
- They share the award with Natalie Obiko Pearson of Bloomberg in the Illustrated Reporting and Commentary category.**
- The Pulitzer Prizes, administered by Columbia University, **are regarded as among the highest honours in journalism, literature and music composition, recognising excellence in reporting and storytelling.**
- The Pulitzer Prizes, **established in 1917** by the will of **Joseph Pulitzer**, are among the most esteemed awards in journalism and the arts.
- These awards span **various categories, including journalism, books, drama, and music**
- It is **administered by Columbia University and named in honor of newspaper publisher Joseph Pulitzer.**
- The awards are **given in 23 categories, with the majority receiving the \$15,000 cash prize and certificate.**
- The **Public Service category** is the only exception, receiving a **gold medal** instead

### Journalism

- Public Service:** The Washington Post
- Breaking News Reporting:** Staff of The Minnesota Star Tribune
- Investigative Reporting:** Staff of The New York Times
- Beat Reporting:** Jeff Horwitz and Engen Tham of Reuters
- Feature Writing:** Aaron Parsley of Texas Monthly
- Illustrated Reporting and Commentary:** Anand RK and Suparna Sharma, contributors, and Natalie Obiko Pearson of Bloomberg

### Books, Drama and Music

- Fiction:** "Angel Down," by Daniel Kraus (Atria Books)
- Drama:** "Liberation," by Bess Wohl
- History:** "We the People: A History of the U.S. Constitution," by Jill Lepore (Liveright)
- Biography:** "Pride and Pleasure: The Schuyler Sisters in an Age of Revolution," by Amanda Vaill (Farrar, Straus and Giroux)
- Memoir or Autobiography:** "Things in Nature Merely Grow," by Yiyun Li (Farrar, Straus and Giroux)
- Poetry:** "Ars Poeticas," by Juliana Spahr (Wesleyan University Press)
- Music:** "Picaflor: A Future Myth," by Gabriela Lena Frank
- Special Citations:** Julie K. Brown

### 12. Which country will host the 1st International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) Summit 2026?

कौन सा देश पहले अंतर्राष्ट्रीय बिग कैट एलायंस (IBCA) शिखर सम्मेलन 2026 की मेज़बानी करेगा?

- A. India
- B. South Africa
- C. Brazil
- D. Kenya

Answer: A

### India to host first Big Cat Summit in June

- Union Environment Minister launched the official website and logo for the 1st International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) Summit 2026 in New Delhi.
- The IBCA is a first-of-its-kind inter-government international organisation and multi-agency coalition.**
- It serves as a global platform uniting 95 big cat range countries, conservation partners, scientific organisations, and business groups to address conservation challenges through cooperation and knowledge sharing.
- Launched In:** April 9, 2023.





- **Headquarters:** The IBCA Secretariat is headquartered in India.

**Aim:**

- The primary objective of IBCA is to halt the decline in big cat populations and reverse current trends.
- It aims to facilitate synergy among stakeholders, consolidate successful conservation practices into a centralized repository, and provide financial and technical support to resource-lacking range countries.
- **The alliance is dedicated to the conservation of seven big cats:** Tiger, Lion, Leopard, Snow Leopard, Cheetah, Jaguar, and Puma

**13. Consider the following statements regarding the Supreme Court:**

1. Parliament has the authority to increase the sanctioned strength of the Supreme Court.
2. Increasing the number of Supreme Court judges requires a Constitutional Amendment.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

**Cabinet approves four more judges for Supreme Court**

- The Union Cabinet approved an increase in the number of judges of the Supreme Court from 34, which includes the Chief Justice of India, to a total 38.
- **The top court currently has a sanctioned strength of 33 judges, including the Chief Justice of India (CJI).**
- A Bill would be brought in the next session of Parliament to raise this strength by four.
- The government's approval for more judges on the Supreme Court is after a six-year hiatus.
- **The Parliament had last amended Section 2 of the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Act, 1956 in 2019, raising the sanctioned strength from 31 to 33 (excluding the Chief Justice of India).**
- The Cabinet approval would be followed by an amendment to the 1956 Act.
- **Article 124(1) gives Parliament the sole authority to increase the sanctioned strength of the Supreme Court.**
- Once the amended law comes into force, the Supreme Court Collegium would recommend judges to the government for appointment to the top court.

**Union Cabinet approves decision to increase strength of Supreme Court from 34 to 38 judges**



**The strength of the Supreme Court has been periodically increased to keep pace with the growing legal workload:**

| Year | Amendment Act         | Sanctioned Strength (Excluding CJI) | Total Strength |
|------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------|
| 1950 | Constitution of India | 7                                   | 8              |
| 1956 | Original Act of 1956  | 10                                  | 11             |
| 2026 | Proposed Bill         | 37                                  | 38             |

**Procedure for Increasing Strength & Appointment**

- **Legislative Amendment:** Since the limit is set by the 1956 Act, any increase requires an Amendment Bill to be passed by both Houses of Parliament (Simple Majority) and receive Presidential Assent.
- **The Proposal:** Usually, the Chief Justice of India (CJI) writes to the government citing the backlog of cases and the need for more benches.

**Appointment (Memorandum of Procedure):**

- Once the strength is increased, the Supreme Court Collegium (consisting of the CJI and the four senior-most judges) recommends names for the new posts.

- The names are sent to the Union Ministry of Law and Justice, which forwards them to the Prime Minister and the President.
- The President of India officially appoints the judges under Article 124(2).

#### 14. Consider the following statements regarding the World Press Freedom Index 2026:

1. India ranked 157th in the index.
2. India improved its ranking compared to 2025.
3. Norway ranked first.
4. Eritrea ranked last.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1, 3 and 4 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 2, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: (a)

#### India Ranks 157 in Press Freedom Index

- India ranked 157th out of 180 countries in the 2026 World Press Freedom Index released by Reporters Without Borders (RSF).
- **Reporters Without Borders is a Paris-based organisation that publishes the World Press Freedom Index every year.**
- The journalism watchdog, originally called Reporters Sans Frontières (RSF)
- **The ranking placed India in the "very serious" category for press freedom, and India fell six places from its 2025 rank of 151.**
- The World Press Freedom Index is an annual ranking prepared by Reporters Without Borders, also known as RSF.
- **Top 5:** Norway (1st for the 10th consecutive year), Netherlands, Estonia, Denmark, and Sweden.
- **Bottom 5:** Eritrea (180th), North Korea, China, Iran, and Saudi Arabia.
- **Most Dangerous Region:** The Middle East and North Africa (MENA) remains the most catastrophic region, with 18 out of 19 countries classified as "difficult" or "very serious".
- **Almost all of India's neighbours rank higher than India** – Pakistan is 153rd, Bhutan is 150th, Nepal is 87th, Sri Lanka is 134th, and Bangladesh is 152nd. China, however, is 178th.



#### 15. The satellite 'Drishti', recently in news, has been developed by:

हाल ही में चर्चा में रहा उपग्रह 'दृष्टि' किसके द्वारा विकसित किया गया है?

- A. Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- B. European Space Agency (ESA)
- C. GalaxEye
- D. National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)

Answer: C

#### First-of-its-kind satellite by Indian start-up flies on SpaceX rocket

- **An Indian start-up, GalaxEye, rode on a SpaceX rocket this morning to launch a first of its kind satellite that is meant to fill a long-standing gap in space imaging. The satellite, aptly called Drishti,**
- **Equipped to take optical images, very much like a normal camera, as well as radar-generated images of the same place at the same time, something that has not been tried before.**
- Drishti is the first satellite of GalaxEye, a company started by alumni of IIT Madras.
- The optical images ensure clarity and intuitiveness, while radar images, through a Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR), brings all-weather reliability.

First-of-its-kind satellite by Indian start-up flies on SpaceX rocket





- It rode on a Falcon 9 rocket by SpaceX from the Vandenberg Space Force Base in California, United States, as one of the 45 payloads on the CAS500-2 mission.

**16. Consider the following statements regarding the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS):**

- The government will provide 100% guarantee coverage to MSMEs under the scheme.
- Non-MSMEs and airlines will receive 20% credit guarantee coverage.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- 1 only
- 2 only
- Both 1 and 2
- Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

**Cabinet Approves Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme 5.0**

- The Union Cabinet approved the fifth edition of its Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme, **under which it will provide additional credit guarantees to micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) and non-MSMEs, including airline companies.**
- The total outlay of the scheme is expected to be ₹18,100 crore, and it is expected to generate additional credit flows worth ₹2.25 lakh crore
- The scheme aims to enable businesses to tide over the challenges arising from the West Asia conflict,"
- Additionally, this is expected to help businesses maintain their operations, protect jobs, and sustain supply chains.
- The scheme is open to MSMEs, non-MSMEs with existing working capital limits, and scheduled passenger airlines that have outstanding credit facilities as of March 31, 2026, as long as their loan accounts are not overdue.**
- Under the scheme, the government will provide 100% coverage to MSMEs and 90% to non-MSMEs and airlines for loans they take for additional credit up to 20% of the peak working capital utilised during the fourth quarter of 2025-26 (capped at Rs.100 crore).
- For airlines, the loans can be for up to 100% of their peak working capital, but this is capped at ₹1,500 crore per borrower, subject to satisfying certain specific conditions.**

**17. Hantavirus Pulmonary Syndrome (HPS) primarily affects which organ?**

हंटावायरस पल्मोनरी सिंड्रोम (HPS) मुख्य रूप से किस अंग को प्रभावित करता है?

- Liver
- Kidneys
- Lungs
- Heart

Answer: (c)

**Hantavirus**

- Recently, three people have died and three are ill after a Netherlands-based cruise ship was hit by a suspected outbreak of hantavirus
- Hantavirus is a strain of virus carried by rodents.
- Transmission: It is transmitted to humans through inhalation of particles from dried rodent droppings.
- People most typically become infected when a virus in rodent droppings, saliva and urine becomes airborne.
- The virus is known to cause two severe illnesses one that primarily affects the lungs and the other that attacks the kidneys.



- Hantavirus Pulmonary Syndrome (HPS): It is a respiratory illness and has a high fatality rate of about 40%.
- Haemorrhagic Fever with Renal Syndrome (HFRS), which is a more severe infection and impacts the kidneys. Symptoms can include low blood pressure, internal bleeding, and acute kidney failure.

**Symptoms**

- Hantavirus usually begins with flu-like symptoms, such as fatigue and fever, one to eight weeks after exposure, according to the CDC.
- Four to 10 days later, coughing, shortness of breath and fluid in the lungs appear.
- Treatment: There is no specific therapy for hantavirus infection, so treatment focuses on supportive care including rest and fluids.

18. What is Project Deepak?

प्रोजेक्ट दीपक क्या है?

- A. A railway connectivity project in Northeast India
- B. A hydroelectric power project in Himachal Pradesh
- C. A BRO project responsible for strategic road infrastructure in Himachal Pradesh
- D. A defence missile development programme under DRDO

**Answer: c**

**Project Deepak**

- Recently, the Project Deepak of Border Roads Organisation (BRO) celebrated its 66th Raising Day at Shimla, Himachal Pradesh.
- About Project Deepak
- It was initiated in 1962 by the Border Roads Organisation.
- The project has been instrumental in executing critical infrastructure works in some of the most challenging terrains of the country.
- Its area of responsibility spans key districts of Himachal Pradesh including Shimla, Kinnaur, Kullu and Lahaul-Spiti.
- Achievements
- Project Deepak- one of the oldest projects- has also been at the forefront of developing critical infrastructure such as Hindustan-Tibet Road and key stretches of Manali-Leh axis.

19. Which country recently introduced its first humanoid robot monk named "Gabi"?

हाल ही में किस देश ने "गाबी" (Gabi) नामक अपना पहला ह्यूमनॉइड रोबोट भिक्षु पेश किया है?

- A. China
- B. Japan
- C. South Korea
- D. Thailand

**Answer: C**

**South Korea Introduces First Humanoid Robot Monk Gabi**

- South Korea introduced its first humanoid robot monk, Gabi, at a Buddhist ceremony at Jogyesa Temple in Seoul
- A humanoid robot is a machine designed with a human-like body structure, including a head, torso, arms, and legs.
- The name combines Siddhartha, the birth name of the Buddha, and jabi, the Korean word for mercy.
- Built on China's Unitree G1 humanoid platform, Dressed in traditional grey-and-brown monk robes, the four-foot-tall robot joined chanting monks, bowed during rituals and even responded to questions during the ceremony.
- Gabi was introduced as part of an initiative by the Jogye Order, which is South Korea's largest Buddhist sect, to modernise Buddhism and connect with younger generations in an increasingly digital society.

- A few weeks ago, researchers at Kyoto University in Japan introduced an AI-powered robot called “Buddharoid”, designed to interact with visitors, learn Buddhist scriptures and respond to spiritual questions.
- Unlike traditional sermon-based systems, Buddharoid was created to hold conversations and adapt to human interactions in real time.

**20. Which state has launched the “Khuarel” mobile application for disaster management?**

किस राज्य ने आपदा प्रबंधन के लिए “खुअरेल” मोबाइल एप्लिकेशन लॉन्च किया है?

- A. Nagaland
- B. Manipur
- C. Mizoram
- D. Tripura

Answer: C

**Mizoram launches ‘Khuarel’ app to boost real-time disaster response**

- Mizoram has launched the “Khuarel” mobile application, a **real-time disaster incident reporting and management system designed to enhance coordination and information flow during emergencies.**
- The app would **allow citizens to quickly report disaster incidents** while enabling authorities, including the State and District Disaster Management Authorities (SDMA & DDMA), to respond more efficiently.

**21. With reference to the Methane Alert and Response System (MARS), consider the following statements:**

1. It is the world’s first satellite-based system for monitoring methane super-emitters.
2. It was officially launched during COP28.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: a

**Methane Alert and Response System (MARS)**

- The UN expanded its Methane Alert and Response System (MARS) to include the coal and waste sectors.
- **This decision follows satellite data identifying an Indian landfill (Kanjurmarg) among the world’s three largest methane emitters, alongside sites in Chile.**
- MARS is the first global satellite-based system that monitors methane super-emitters and connects that data to rapid mitigation efforts. It is a component of the International Methane Emissions Observatory (IMEO) under the UN Environment Programme (UNEP).
- **Launched In:** The system was announced at COP27 and officially launched in January 2023.
- **Aim:** The primary goal is to identify and quantify major methane emission events, notify relevant governments and companies, and track the progress of their mitigation actions to slow global heating.



**How it Works?**

**The system operates through a four-step lifecycle:**

- **Detection and Attribution:** MARS scans data from over 35 satellites to identify large methane plumes. High-resolution imagery then attributes these plumes to specific facilities and operators.

**22. The 2026 Whitley Awards recognise:**

2026 व्हिटली पुरस्कार निम्नलिखित को मान्यता देते हैं:

- A. Excellence in sports achievements
- B. Grassroots conservation leadership and biodiversity protection
- C. Innovations in space technology

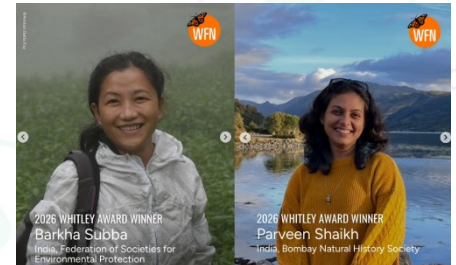


## D. Contributions to literature and arts

Answer: B

**The Whitley Award 2026**

- Barkha Subba and Parveen Shaikh have won the prestigious 2026 Whitley Awards from India, for their work on protecting the habitat of the Himalayan Salamander and community led protection of the nesting sites of Indian Skimmer on the Chambal river.
- Barkha, is a scientific adviser at Darjeeling based Federation of Societies for Environmental Protection will lead the first coordinated grassroots effort to secure the future of the Himalayan salamander in Darjeeling.
- Endemic to India, Nepal and Bhutan, the Himalayan salamander, which can grow up to 17 cm in length and live for up to 11 years.
- **Conservation Status:** IUCN: Vulnerable.
- Parveen was recognised for her community-led "Guardians of the Skimmer" initiative on the Chambal River.
- Once widely distributed across Southeast Asia, the Indian Skimmer has disappeared from most of its historic range amid the large-scale degradation of river habitats.
- **IUCN Red List Status:** Endangered

**About Whitley Awards**

- It is often called as the "Green Oscars,"
- It recognises grassroots conservation leaders in the Global South.
- It is given by the UK charity Whitley Fund for Nature (WFN).
- It provides winners with £50,000 in project funding over one year to scale up local solutions to biodiversity loss.

**23. The "Pathfinder" satellite, recently seen in news, is being developed by which organisations?**

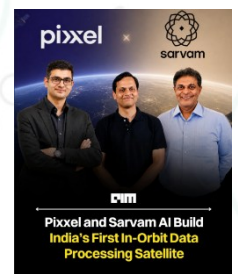
हाल ही में खबरों में देखा गया उपग्रह "पाथफाइंडर" किन संगठनों द्वारा विकसित किया जा रहा है?

- Pixxel and Sarvam AI
- Indian Space Research Organisation and Infosys Limite
- Defence Research and Development Organisation and Tata Consultancy Services
- National Aeronautics and Space Administration and OpenAI

Answer: (a)

**Pixxel to launch India's first orbital data centre satellite this year**

- Space-tech startup Pixxel, announced a partnership with LLM provider Sarvam AI to develop and build India's first orbital data centre satellite called The Pathfinder.
- Expected to reach orbit by the end of 2026, the 200-kg satellite will house GPUs (graphics processing units) that will be used to carry out training and inference of Sarvam's AI model.
- Unlike conventional satellite computing, which relies on low-power edge processors optimised for survival rather than performance, the Pathfinder satellite will house the same generation of hardware as on-ground data centres used to power frontier AI models.

**Pixxel-Sarvam partnership**

- As part of the partnership, Pixxel said it will design, build, launch, and operate the Pathfinder satellite.
- The satellite will be developed at Gigapixxel, the company's upcoming facility that will be designed to scale satellite production to up to 100 units. Sarvam, on the other hand, will handle the training and inference of its language models directly in orbit.

## 24. The Vadinar Ship Repair Facility project will be jointly implemented by which two organisations?

वदिनार जहाज़ मरम्मत सुविधा परियोजना का संयुक्त रूप से किन दो संगठनों द्वारा कार्यान्वयन किया जाएगा?

- A. Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority and Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- B. Deendayal Port Authority and Cochin Shipyard Limited
- C. Shipping Corporation of India and Hindustan Shipyard Limited
- D. Paradip Port Authority and Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers

Answer: B.

### Cabinet approves ship repair facility in Vadinar with an investment of ₹1,570 crore

- The government approved the development of a state-of-the-art ship repair facility in Vadinar, Gujarat, with an investment of ₹1,570 crore.
- The project will be jointly implemented by Deendayal Port Authority (DPA) and Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL).
- **The project is planned as a brownfield facility with a 650-metre jetty, two large floating dry docks, workshops and associated marine infrastructure.**
- **Vadinar's natural deep draft, connectivity to major shipping routes, and proximity to key ports, such as Mundra and Kandla, make it an optimal location for repair operations, particularly for large commercial and foreign-flagged vessels.**
- The Vadinar Ship Repair Facility will directly address a critical gap in India's ship repair infrastructure, as the country currently lacks adequate domestic capacity to repair large vessels exceeding 230 metres in length.
- **By enabling repair of vessels up to 300 m, the facility will allow high-value repairs of large vessels within India.**



## 25. The Centre approved the Mission for Cotton Productivity for which period?

केंद्र ने कपास उत्पादकता मिशन को किस अवधि के लिए मंजूरी दी?

- A. 2025–26 to 2027–28
- B. 2026–27 to 2030–31
- C. 2027–28 to 2032–33
- D. 2026–27 to 2035–36

Answer: B

### Mission for Cotton Productivity

- **The Centre approved Rs 5,659.22 crore for the Mission for Cotton Productivity for five years (2026–27 to 2030–31). The scheme was announced in the Union Budget 2025-26.**
- It aims to provide “the best of science & technology support” to farmers and “ensure a steady supply of quality cotton” for the Indian textile industry.
- Aligned with the 5F vision (Farm to Fibre to Factory to Fashion to Foreign) of the Government for the textile sector, this scheme will help in increasing the incomes of farmers and ensure a steady supply of quality cotton for rejuvenating India's traditional textile sector.



### The mission focuses on:

- (i) Development of **seeds that are high-yielding**, climate resilient, and pest-resistant
- (ii) Upscaling of **cotton production technologies** like High Density Planting System (HDPS), Closer Spacing (CS), Integrated Cotton Management, and promotion of Extra Long Staple (ELS) Cotton
- (iii) Promoting **modernization of ginning and processing factories**, including the adoption of best processing practices.
- (iv) Modern, standardized, and accredited cotton testing infrastructure to ensure reliable quality assessment and global benchmarking.
- (v) **Branding and creating premium** value for cotton to position it as a globally trusted product under the Kasturi Cotton Bharat initiative



- (vi) **Digital integration of mandis, enabling** transparent price discovery, direct market access, and incorporating e-platforms to empower farmers
- (vii) **Promotion of circular** economy by focussing on cotton waste recycling to enhance resource efficiency, reduce environmental footprint, and generate additional value streams for the industry
- (viii) **Diversification of India's fibre base by including natural fibres like flax, ramie, sisal, milkweed, bamboo** and banana to complement cotton and align India's textile sector with evolving global demand patterns.

- The Mission envisages to accomplish the production of 498 lakh bales (170 kg lint each) of cotton by enhancing lint productivity from 440 kg/ha to 755 kg/ha by 2031," .
- **According to the Ministry of Agriculture, India's cotton production stood at 290.91 lakh bales during 2025-26, with Maharashtra, Gujarat, Telangana, Karnataka and Rajasthan the top five producers in the country.**

#### MSP for Cotton

- **The Cotton Corporation of India Limited (CCI) has been nominated by the Government of India for undertaking MSP operations in the event when prices of seed cotton (kapas) fall below the MSP level for procuring kapas offered by the cotton farmers.**
- MSP is the price at which the government is supposed to procure/buy that crop from farmers if the market price falls below it. MSPs provide a floor for market prices and ensure that farmers receive a certain "minimum" remuneration so that their costs of cultivation (and some profit) can be recovered.
- **The MSPs are announced by the Union government on the recommendations of the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP). CACP is an attached office of the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare.**
- It is an advisory body whose recommendations are not binding on the Government.
- **The CACP recommends MSPs for 22 mandated crops** and fair and remunerative price (FRP) for sugarcane

#### Kasturi Cotton Bharat

- Kasturi Cotton Bharat focuses on three pillars: Traceability, Certification, and Branding to enhance the value of Indian cotton.
- **The objective is to enhance the global perception and value of Indian cotton by positioning 'Kasturi Cotton Bharat' as a high-quality, competitively priced product in both domestic and international markets.**
- Kasturi Cotton Bharat is a certification and branding initiative for lint cotton bales after processing.

#### 26. Consider the following statements regarding Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram (RBSK):

1. It covers children from birth up to 18 years of age.
2. The programme includes free treatment including surgeries at tertiary level.
3. It excludes newborn screening at delivery points.

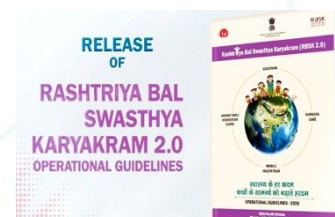
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

#### Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram

- **Recently, the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare released the Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram (RBSK) 2.0 Guidelines.**
- It was **launched in February, 2013** under the National Rural Health Mission.
- It is a program to improve the overall quality of life of children and provide comprehensive care to all the children in the community.
- This program involves screening of children from birth to 18 years of age for four Ds- Defects at birth, Diseases, Deficiencies and Development delays.
- Under this programme, its screening spans 32 common health conditions for early detection and free treatment and management, including surgeries at tertiary level.





**Major strategies followed are**

- **Comprehensive newborn screening** – at delivery points to screen birth defects of the newborn
- **Community screening at the Anganwadi and Government schools for children in the age group 0 -18 years** in convergence with Ministry of Women and Child Development and Ministry of Education
- Screening of the newborns/infants by ASHA through the HBNC/HBYC program as a part of Early Childhood Development
- Therapeutic management of the identified children at the District Early Intervention Centres (DEIC)...

**Key Feature of RBSK 2.0**

- It has **expanded screening scope, covering a wider range of conditions including**, Developmental disorders, mental health issues, behavioural concerns, lifestyle risks, risk factors for non-communicable diseases such as diabetes and hypertension, and additional conditions like kidney disorders,
- It has introduced digital health cards, real-time data systems, and integrated platforms for tracking, monitoring and service delivery....

**27. Mahendragiri, recently delivered to the Indian Navy, belongs to which class of warships?**

महेंद्रगिरि, जिसे हाल ही में भारतीय नौसेना को सौंपा गया है, युद्धपोतों की किस श्रेणी से संबंधित है?

- A. Kolkata-class destroyers
- B. Nilgiri-class frigates
- C. Shivalik-class corvettes
- D. Kamorta-class anti-submarine vessels

**Answer: B**

**DELIVERY OF PROJECT 17A INDIGENOUS ADVANCED STEALTH FRIGATE 'MAHENDRAGIRI'**

- **Mahendragiri (Yard 12654), the sixth ship of Nilgiri-class (Project 17A) and fourth ship of the class built at Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDSL), was delivered to the Indian Navy on 30 Apr 2026 at MDSL, Mumbai.**
- Project 17A frigates are versatile multi-mission platforms designed to address current and emerging challenges in the maritime domain.
- This state-of-the-art frigate reflects a quantum leap in naval design, stealth, firepower, automation, and survivability, and stands as an admirable symbol of Aatmanirbharta in warship building
- Designed by the Warship Design Bureau (WDB) and overseen by the Warship Overseeing Team (Mumbai),
- **P17A frigates reflect a generational leap in indigenous ship design, stealth, survivability, and combat capability. P17A ships are fitted with an advanced weapon and sensor suite as compared to the P17 (Shivalik-class).**

**28. Mishra Dhatu Nigam Limited (MIDHANI) operates under which ministry?**

मिश्र धातु निगम लिमिटेड (MIDHANI) किस मंत्रालय के अंतर्गत संचालित होता है?

- (a) Ministry of Heavy Industries
- (b) Ministry of Steel
- (c) Ministry of Science and Technology
- (d) Ministry of Defence

**Answer: (d)**

**MIDHANI launches advanced Aerospace Fasteners facility**

- **Mishra Dhatu Nigam Limited (MIDHANI), a premier Defence Public Sector Undertaking under the Ministry of Defence, marked a significant milestone with the inauguration of its state-of-the-art Aerospace Fasteners Facility at its Hyderabad plant .**
- **The new facility is designed to ensure high precision, consistency and efficiency in the manufacture of aerospace-grade fasteners.**
- **MIDHANI will manufacture a wide range of critical fasteners at the facility, including special steel fasteners engineered to withstand extreme aerospace conditions, titanium fasteners offering superior strength-to-**

weight performance, and superalloy fasteners capable of operating in high-temperature and corrosive environments.

**29. Which state has been declared India's first fully paperless State judiciary?**

किस राज्य को भारत की पहली पूर्णतः पेपरलेस राज्य न्यायपालिका घोषित किया गया है?

- A. Goa
- B. Sikkim
- C. Himachal Pradesh
- D. Uttarakhand

Answer: b

**CJI Justice Surya Kant declares Sikkim as the first paperless state judiciary in the country in event being held in Gangtok**



- Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant declared Sikkim as the country's first fully paperless State judiciary, marking a decisive shift in court administration and adjudicatory processes towards a digitised, technology-driven framework.
- The development coincides with Sikkim's 50th Statehood anniversary, Sikkim celebrates its Statehood Day on May 16

**30. Suchi Semicon Private Limited (SSPL) will establish an OSAT facility in:**

सुची सेमीकॉन प्राइवेट लिमिटेड (SSPL) एक OSAT सुविधा स्थापित करेगा:

- A. Ahmedabad
- B. Surat
- C. Gandhinagar
- D. Bhavnagar

Answer: B

**Cabinet approves Micro LED plant, OSAT facility in Gujarat**

- The Union cabinet approved support worth a combined ₹3,936 crore in support for two new semiconductor plants by Crystal Matrix Ltd and Suchi Semicon Pvt Ltd.
- These are the final projects to be approved under the first phase of the India Semiconductor Mission.
- The details of the two approved proposals are as follows:
- Crystal Matrix Limited (CML) will establish an integrated facility for compound semiconductor fabrication and ATMP in Dholera, Gujarat for manufacturing Mini/Micro-LED display modules.
- The annual proposed production capacity for Mini/Micro-LED Display Panels is 72,000 sq. meters, and for Mini-Micro-LED GaN Epitaxy Wafers is 24,000 sets of RGB wafers.
- The proposed products will have applications in large displays for TVs and signages/commercial displays, Medium-sized displays for tablets, smartphones, and in-car displays, and Micro-displays for Extended Reality (XR) glasses and smart watches.
- Suchi Semicon Private Limited (SSPL) will be setting up an Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) facility in Surat, Gujarat for manufacturing discrete semiconductors.
- The proposed production capacity of the Suchi Semicon is 1033.20 million chips per annum.
- The target applications include power electronics, analog ICs, and industrial systems, serving end markets such as automotive, industrial automation, and consumer electronics.

**31. Which of the following commissions recommended the order of precedence in government formation during a hung Assembly?**

1. Sarkaria Commission
2. Punchhi Commission
3. Administrative Reforms Commission

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 2 only

C. 2 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B

### Governor's Role in a Hung Assembly

- Actor-turned-politician Vijay's swearing-in as Tamil Nadu Chief Minister has been delayed as Governor Rajendra Arlekar insisted on proof of majority before an invitation to form the government
- A hung Assembly occurs when no single political party or pre-poll alliance secures an absolute majority of seats in the state legislature.
- In such situations, the Governor exercises constitutional discretion to appoint a Chief Minister who, in their judgment, is most likely to command the confidence of the House.

### Constitutional Article:

- Article 164(1): The Constitution of India provides that the Chief Minister shall be appointed by the Governor.
- Aim:
- The primary aim of the Governor's role is to ensure the formation of a stable government that commands the widest possible support in the Legislative Assembly.
- The Governor's task is purely administrative—to see that a government is formed—rather than political.
- Governor's Role & Order of Precedence:
- Based on the norms established by the Sarkaria Commission (1983) and the Punchhi Commission (2007), the Governor should follow a specific order of precedence:
- Pre-poll Alliance: Invite the group of parties that contested the election together and command the largest number of seats.
- Single Largest Party: Invite the single largest party that can demonstrate it has gained the support of others to reach a majority.
- Post-election Coalition: Invite a post-poll alliance where all constituent parties agree to join the government.
- Outside Support: Invite a post-election alliance where some parties join the government and others (including Independents) provide support from the outside.

### Key Procedures:

- Floor Test: The Commission norms emphasize that the issue of majority support must be tested on the floor of the House (Assembly) and not determined by the Governor privately.
- Timeframe: A newly appointed Chief Minister is typically required to seek a vote of confidence within 30 days of taking office.

### 32. The Vikram VT-21 project has been developed by:

विक्रम VT-21 परियोजना किसके द्वारा विकसित की गई है?

- (a) Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
- (b) Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)
- (c) Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
- (d) Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)

Answer: (c)

### Vikram VT 21

- The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) recently launched its Vikram VT 21 project with two Advanced Armoured Platforms wheeled and tracked.
- An Advanced Armoured Platform (AAP), Vikram VT 21 is a modern military combat vehicle built with enhanced armour protection to withstand certain projectiles, blasts, and shrapnel plus which has improved mobility across varied terrains and integrated weapons and surveillance systems.
- The Vikram VT 21 project includes two variants. First is wheeled, which run on tyres and are faster, easier to maintain, and better suited for roads and urban and semi urban environments.
- Second is tracked, which moves on continuous tracks like tanks, offering superior grip, stability, and performance on rough, uneven, or off-road terrain.



- These vehicles are fitted with an indigenously designed 30 mm crewless turret a remotely operated gun system mounted on top, with no soldier sitting inside it built to improve mobility, firepower and protection.

### 33. Which institute ranked highest among Indian institutions in the QS Executive MBA Rankings 2026?

QS Executive MBA Rankings 2026 में भारतीय संस्थानों में से किस संस्थान को सर्वोच्च स्थान प्राप्त हुआ?

- A. IIM Bangalore
- B. IIM Ahmedabad
- C. IIM Calcutta
- D. ISB Hyderabad

Answer: A

#### QS MBA Rankings 2026: IIM Bengaluru Tops India

- The Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Bangalore has ranked the highest among Indian institutions in the QS Executive MBA rankings 2026, but recorded a sharp fall of 14 ranks compared to the previous year.
- IIM Bangalore ranked 64th globally this year, the institute's lowest rank so far. It is, however, the only Indian institute in the top 100.
- IIM Bangalore's descent has been steady over the last four years.
- Global higher education analysts QS Quacquarelli Symonds released the rankings
- IIM Kozhikode (151-160 rank band, marginally better than 161-170 last year).
- IIM Indore (161-170, up from 181-90 last year), Institute of Management Technology, Ghaziabad (191-200, down from 181-190 last year), and Woxsen School of Business, Hyderabad (191-200, same as last year).

| Institution                                   | 2026 rank | 2025 rank |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|
| IIM Bangalore                                 | 64        | 50        |
| Indian School of Business                     | 111-120   | 111-120   |
| IIM Kozhikode                                 | 151-160   | 161-170   |
| IIM Indore                                    | 161-170   | 181-190   |
| Institute of Management Technology, Ghaziabad | 191-200   | 181-190   |
| Woxsen School of Business, Hyderabad          | 191-200   | 191-200   |
| IIM Ranchi                                    | 201+      | NA        |

#### IIM Ranchi has made the rankings as a new entrant this year, at 201+.

- Globally, the top institution in the executive MBA rankings is the University of Oxford, followed by HEC Paris and MIT Sloan School of Management.
- The National University of Singapore Business School is the highest-ranked institution in Asia-Pacific. City University of Hong Kong makes its first appearance in the rankings, ranking 58th.

### 34. The headquarters of CARICOM is located in:

CARICOM का मुख्यालय स्थित है:

- (a) Kingston, Jamaica
- (b) Port of Spain, Trinidad
- (c) Georgetown, Guyana
- (d) Bridgetown, Barbados

Answer: (c)

## CARICOM

- The External Affairs Minister recently arrived in Kingston, Jamaica, at the start of his own nine-day visit to the Caribbean 'CARICOM' grouping of countries.
- CARICOM, which stands for Caribbean Community, is the oldest surviving integration movement in the developing world.
- It is an organization of Caribbean countries and dependencies originally established as the Caribbean Community and Commons Market in 1973 by the Treaty of Chaguaramas.
- It replaced the former Caribbean Free Trade Association (CARIFTA), which had become effective in 1968.
- The treaty spurred the development of associate institutions, including the Caribbean Development Bank and the Organization of East Caribbean States, both of which promote economic growth and cooperation.
- In July 2001 the heads of government revised the Treaty of Chaguaramas, establishing the Caribbean Community and the CARICOM Single Market and Economy (CSME), which would harmonize economic policy and create a single currency.
- In 2007, CARICOM officially inaugurated the Caribbean Court of Justice (CCJ), which serves as the final court of appeal for CARICOM members and also handles regional trade disputes



### Members:

- **It has 15 members;** Antigua and Barbuda, The Bahamas, Barbados, Belize, Dominica, Grenada, Guyana, Haiti, Jamaica, Montserrat, Saint Kitts and Nevis, Saint Lucia, Saint Vincent and the Grenadines, Suriname, and Trinidad and Tobago.
- **Of the 15, all except Montserrat are nation-states.**
- Anguilla, Bermuda, British Virgin Islands, Cayman Islands, and Turks & Caicos Islands are associate members of the community.
- The **chairmanship of the community is rotated every six months among the member countries' heads.**
- The **permanent secretariat headquarter** - Georgetown, Guyana.

35. Who among the following became the first man to win five ATP Masters 1000 titles consecutively ?

निम्नलिखित में से कौन लगातार पाँच ATP मास्टर्स 1000 खिताब जीतने वाला पहला पुरुष बना?

- (a) Novak Djokovic
- (b) Carlos Alcaraz
- (c) Jannik Sinner
- (d) Daniil Medvedev

Answer: (c)

### Marta Kostyuk Wins Madrid Open 2026

- In Tennis, Marta Kostyuk has captured the the women's singles title after winning the Madrid Open 2026, defeated world No. 8 Mirra Andreeva .
- Jannik Sinner , The world No. 1 made more history at the Madrid Open 2026, becoming the first man to claim five Masters 1000 titles in a row and putting him on the cusp of a series sweep with eight of the nine events just below tennis' Grand Slams.

### Singles Results

Men's Singles Final: Jannik Sinner (1) defeated Alexander Zverev (2) 6–1, 6–2.

Women's Singles Final: Marta Kostyuk (26) defeated Mirra Andreeva

### Doubles Results

Men's Doubles Final: Henry Patten and Harri Heliövaara defeated Guido Andreozzi and Manuel Guinard.

Women's Doubles Final: Kateřina Siniaková and Taylor Townsend (2) defeated Mirra Andreeva and Diana Shnaider

36. "Project Freedom," recently seen in news, is associated with:

“प्रोजेक्ट फ्रीडम” , जो हाल ही में खबरों में देखा गया था, किससे संबंधित है?

- (a) NATO naval exercises in the Mediterranean Sea
- (b) European Union anti-piracy operation
- (c) UN humanitarian mission in the Red Sea
- (d) United States initiative to guide stranded ships in the Strait of Hormuz

Answer: d



**Trump announces 'Project Freedom' to help stranded ships leave Strait of Hormuz**

- The United States will launch an effort to “guide” stranded ships from the Iran-gripped Strait of Hormuz - “Project Freedom”
- US will “help free up” ships stuck in the Strait of Hormuz, suggesting that his administration will break Iran’s blockade of the strategic waterway.

**37. Which of the following best distinguishes EGRs from Gold ETFs?**

निम्नलिखित में से कौन EGRs और Gold ETFs के बीच सबसे बेहतर ढंग से अंतर स्पष्ट करता है?

- (a) EGRs are not tradable on exchanges
- (b) Gold ETFs represent physical gold, while EGRs do not
- (c) EGRs represent physical gold stored in vaults, whereas ETFs are fund units investing in gold
- (d) There is no difference between the two

Answer: (c)

**NSE Launches Electronic Gold Receipts**

- National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) announced the launch of Electronic Gold Receipts (EGRs), a new segment aimed at bringing greater transparency, efficiency and formalisation to India's gold market
- The NSE stated that the launch, effective from May 4, 2026, is expected to bridge the gap between physical gold and financial markets by offering a regulated and secure platform for trading in gold.

**What are EGRs and how do they work?**

- EGR is an electronic receipt issued against physical gold deposited with a Sebi-accredited vault manager.
- These are dematerialised securities and are tradable on the exchange like a stock, thus seamlessly integrating gold into the formal financial system. These EGRs represent real gold stored securely in vaults.
- It successfully dematerialised a gold bar of 1000 grams into an Electronic Gold Receipt, symbolising the conversion of physical gold into a secure and tradable electronic instrument

**How are EGRs different from gold ETFs?**

- The core difference between EGRs and gold ETFs is the underlying asset. While EGR represent physical gold in a vault, ETFs are units of a fund that invests in gold.





**38. Consider the following statements regarding the Korowai tribe:**

1. Cannibalism is a universally practiced cultural norm among them today.
2. They are indigenous to Papua in Indonesia.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only  
(b) 2 only  
(c) Both 1 and 2  
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: (b)**

**Korowai Tribe**

- Papua's Korowai tribe, often labelled 'cannibals', is re-examined as myths fade, revealing a misunderstood culture shaped by isolation, conflict, and historical misrepresentation.
- The Korowai tribe is a group of indigenous people who live in the southeastern part of Papua, Indonesia.
- They hunt and gather food from the forest, including wild animals and plants.
- They are living high up in the trees which they built on the tree trunks.
- They build tree houses to protect their homes from floods and wild animals, as well as to keep them safe from rival tribes.
- The Korowai people were totally disconnected from the outside world until the 1970s.
- They have been sensationalised in modern media for their association with cannibalism, a practice of eating human flesh.

**39. With reference to the UDGM portal, which of the following statements is correct?**

UDGM पोर्टल के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा कथन सही है?

- A. It is operated by SEBI for tracing inactive demat accounts.  
B. It enables inter-bank transfer of dormant deposits.  
C. It acts as a search platform for unclaimed bank deposits.  
D. It is meant only for public sector banks.

**Answer: C**

**UDGM Portal**

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) recently told the Supreme Court that 30 banks have been integrated into its centralised web portal, UDGM, to enable legal heirs to trace funds belonging to deceased account holders.
- UDGM (Unclaimed Deposits-Gateway to Access inforMation) is an online portal developed by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).
- The RBI collaborated with Reserve Bank Information Technology Pvt Ltd (ReBIT), Indian Financial Technology & Allied Services (IFTAS), and selected banks to develop this platform.
- It facilitates the registered users to search unclaimed deposits/accounts across multiple banks at one place in a centralized manner.
- All unclaimed deposits/accounts that are part of the DEA Fund of RBI can be searched in the UDGM portal.
- It provides information related to both individual and non-individual category of unclaimed deposits.
- Whether a user can settle/claim his/her unclaimed deposits through UDGM portal?
- No, the UDGM portal facilitates only
- the search of unclaimed deposits/accounts across multiple banks at one place and provides information on the claim/settlement process of each bank (which will be available in the search result).
- The unclaimed deposits can be claimed only from the respective bank.

**What is the Unclaimed Deposit Reference Number (UDRN)?**

- After registration on the UDGM portal, a person will get UDRN, which is a unique number generated through Core Banking Solution (CBS) by banks and assigned to each Unclaimed account/ deposit transferred to the DEA Fund of RBI.

**What are Unclaimed Deposits?**

- According to RBI, “Unclaimed Deposits” refers to funds held in savings or current accounts that have remained inactive for a duration of 10 years, or in the case of fixed deposits (FDs), have not been withdrawn within 10 years from the maturity date.
- Such amounts are transferred by banks to the “Depositor Education and Awareness” (DEA) Fund, which is maintained by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

**40. Consider the following statements regarding the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) crime data 2024:**

1. Delhi recorded the highest number of crimes against senior citizens among metropolitan cities.
2. Bengaluru reported the highest number of child abduction cases among metropolitan cities.

**Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?**

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

**Delhi Tops NCRB Data in Child Crimes**

- Data released by the National Crime Records Bureau for 2024 showed a notable decline in the number of crimes registered in Delhi, even as several categories of violent and targeted offences continued to raise serious concerns for law enforcement agencies.
- Delhi reported the highest number of such crimes, far ahead of other metropolitan cities such as Chennai (466), Bengaluru (386), Hyderabad (316), and Ahmedabad (295).
- The figures indicated that overall IPC and BNS crimes in the national capital fell by 15.1% compared with the previous year.
- The data was particularly concerning in relation to crimes against children, where Delhi continued to report the highest numbers among major metropolitan cities.
- The disparity was especially stark in child abduction cases. Delhi registered 5,404 such cases, far exceeding Mumbai's 1,831 and Bengaluru's 1,136.
- Crimes against elderly
- The Capital also reported a decline in crimes against senior citizens between 2022 and 2024, though it still recorded the highest number of such cases among all metropolitan cities.
- Mumbai reported the second-highest number of such crimes at 791, followed by Bengaluru (660), Kochi (263), and Nagpur (204).

**Important Headlines**

- TIPRA Motha party (TMP) appointed Runiel Debbarma as the new chief executive member (CEM), after winning the Tripura Tribal Areas Autonomous District Council (TTAADC) polls for the second time on April 17.
- Former Indian cricketer Ambati Rayudu has been appointed as the Director of Cricket Operations for the Hyderabad Cricket Association (HCA).
- Mahanagar Gas Ltd has announced that Praveer Kumar Srivastava has taken over as its Managing Director.
- Ravi K. has taken charge as the 22nd Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Bengaluru-headquartered Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL).
- Noted filmmaker Ashutosh Gowariker has been appointed as the Festival Director for the 57th edition of the International Film Festival of India (IFFI), to be held in Goa.
- Bharat Khera has assumed charge as Secretary in the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises.
- Infosys has announced that the Board of Directors has approved the appointment of Nitin Paranjpe as non-executive Vice Chairman of the Board with immediate effect, as per the company's regulatory filing.
- Governor Thaawarchand Gehlot has appointed retired IAS officer Sathyavathi G. as the Chief Information Commissioner of the Karnataka Information Commission.
- The government has appointed Rohit Jain as a deputy Governor of the Reserve Bank of India

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi has approved the appointment of Dr R Balasubramaniam and Dr Joram Aniya as full-time members of NITI Aayog.
- Commodore Jasvinder Singh has assumed charge as Director (Strategic Projects) at Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL).
- The Visakhapatnam Port Authority (VPA) has won two gold trophies at the Greentech CSR Awards 2026 in Healthcare Promotion and Skill Development categories within Andhra Pradesh.
- The International Education group at Cambridge University Press & Assessment (Cambridge) announced science teacher, Soma Mandal, as the regional winner of the 2026 Cambridge Dedicated Teacher Awards in the South Asia region.
- The Indian Express photographer Sankhadeep Banerjee has won the Photojournalism category of the Asian College of Journalism (ACJ) Journalism Awards 2025, for his image titled “Protestors at rest”.
- The Andaman and Nicobar administration set a new Guinness World Record by unfurling the world’s largest underwater national flag at Radhanagar beach.
- Kalaburagi-based/Karnataka artist M. G. Doddamani has been selected for the Karnataka Lalithakala Academy’s Honorary Award for 2024-25, in recognition of his contribution to the visual arts.
- CSIR-Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI), in collaboration with Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL), has been recognized by the India Book of Records and Asia Book of Records for establishing the record titled “First Roadblock Section Constructed Using Technical Textile Geocell Made from End-of-Life Plastic.”
- Ted Turner, media pioneer and the outspoken businessman who reshaped global television news by launching CNN in 1980, has died at the age of 87.
- The Supreme Court of India observed that the Medical Termination of Pregnancy (MTP) Act needs further amendment to address the rising cases of unwanted pregnancies, especially among minors.
- The Union Cabinet gave the go-ahead to amend The Prevention of Insults To National Honour Act, 1971 to make any insult or obstruction to the singing of National Song Vande Mataram a punishable offence.
- The Union Government has extended the duty-free import of yellow peas and black gram until March 2027.
- The Union Cabinet approved the fifth edition of its Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme, under which it will provide additional credit guarantees to micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) and non-MSMEs, including airline companies.
- The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved three multitracking projects of the Railway Ministry with a total cost of ₹23,437 crore.
- The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs, increased the Fair and Remunerative Price (FRP) of sugarcane for the sugar season 2026-27 (October-September) by ₹10 for a quintal from the last crop year, new price will be ₹365 per quintal for a basic sugar recovery rate of 10.25%.
- Recently, the Ministry of Mines has approved 58 companies under the Incentive Scheme for Promotion of Critical Mineral Recycling as eligible for participation.
- The North Eastern Handicrafts and Handlooms Development Corporation (NEHDC) officially launched ‘Padma Doree’, a cross-regional initiative merging Northeast India’s Eri silk with Madhya Pradesh’s Chanderi traditions.
- The Union Home Ministry notified the Citizenship (Amendment) Rules, 2026 on May 1, 2026, to modernize the Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) framework.
- The Atomic Energy Regulatory Board (AERB) has granted permission for the erection of major equipment, including Reactor Pressure Vessels and Steam Generators, for Units 5 and 6 of the Kudankulam Nuclear Power Project (KKNPP).
- The Bureau of Indian Standards BIS has published several standards for medical assistive technologies as a part of the National List of Essential Assistive Products NLEAP initiative brought about by Indian Council of Medical Research.
- Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC), along with CSIR–National Chemical Laboratory (CSIR-NCL), is set to launch an industrial pilot project to produce dimethyl ether (DME) in Pune.



- The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare has launched JANANI (Journey of Antenatal, Natal and Neonatal Integrated Care) as a significant step towards strengthening maternal and child healthcare services in the country.
- The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) organised the 'Run for Sun' Marathon, on the occasion of International Sun Day, as a tribute to the 'Saur Shakti' lighting the world.
- New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani said,, that he will encourage King Charles III to return the Koh-i-Noor diamond to India. Koh-i-Noor is called the 'blood diamond' .
- The Komagata Maru incident was recently highlighted by singer Diljit Dosanjh during his appearance on The Tonight Show Starring Jimmy Fallon.
- Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister ordered a high-level inquiry following a tragic cruise boat capsize at Bargi Dam that resulted in nine deaths. Bargi Dam is one of the most significant multipurpose river valley projects in Central India.
- Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant declared Sikkim as the country's first fully paperless State judiciary, marking a decisive shift in court administration and adjudicatory processes towards a digitised, technology-driven framework.
- Nagaland Health Protection Society Launches '100 Days Ayushman Student Coverage Mission' to Expand Youth Health Coverage
- Mizoram declared 'insurgency-free' as last militant group lays down arms
- A first-of-its-kind module on Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership philosophy has been added to the sociology syllabus of the Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda, one of western India's oldest public universities.
- Union Minister of Road Transport & Highways Shri Nitin Gadkari announced the launch of India's first Multi-Lane Free Flow (MLFF) barrier-less tolling system at the Chorayasi Toll Plaza on the Surat–Bharuch section of NH-48 in Gujarat.
- The 2nd edition of WAVES Doc Bazaar will return from June 16 to 18, 2026, alongside the 19th Mumbai International Film Festival (MIFF), at the NFDC Complex, Mumbai.
- The Operation WHITE STRIKE led to the seizure of 349 kg of high-grade cocaine worth ₹1,745 crore in the Mumbai logistics corridor.
- Morarji Desai National Institute of Yoga (MDNIY), under the Ministry of Ayush, will organise Yoga Mahotsav 2026, marking the 50-day countdown to 12th International Day of Yoga (IDY 2026) on May 02, 2026, at Kanha Shanti Vanam, Ranga Reddy district, Telangana.
- The Telangana government in a few days will launch a mobile app (TG Organics) to connect organic farmers with customers.
- The annual Mahua flower festival, locally known as 'Ippa Puvvu Panduga', was celebrated with traditional fervour in Jamidi village of Adilabad district, Telangana.
- "Startup Kadapa" is an ambitious project in Kadapa, Andhra Pradesh, aimed at nurturing entrepreneurial talent and providing a platform for youth to explore new opportunities.
- Ministry of Earth Sciences Secretary M. Ravichandran inaugurated the Coastal Atmospheric Research Testbed (C-ART) at Andhra University in Visakhapatnam.
- Karnataka government launches India's first digital grievance redressal system for gig workers
- The Kerala State Biodiversity Board has launched a pilot programme to restore sacred groves (kavus) across selected districts.
- The Chitra Pournami festival at the Mangala Devi Kannagi Temple on the Keralam – Tamil Nadu border held.
- The Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), Pune, operating under the 'Mission Mausam' initiative, has established a state-of-the-art Urban Testbed and Aerosol Observatory at the SRM Institute of Science and Technology (SRMIST) in Ramapuram, Chennai.
- The Indian Institute of Technology Madras Global Research Foundation has announced the establishment of its first centre in the United States, expanding India's deep-tech innovation footprint into global ecosystems.

- The Chief of Defence Staff, General Anil Chauhan, inaugurated a conference on 'Brain-Computer Interface(BCI): Expanding Neural Frontiers & Its Strategic Implications' jointly organised by Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff (HQ IDS) and the Centre for Joint Warfare Studies at New Delhi on May 05, 2026.
- The Indian Army contingent has departed to Cambodia for the second edition of India-Cambodia Bilateral Military Exercise CINBAX-II.
- India has successfully conducted the second flight test of its long-range hypersonic anti-ship missile (LR-ASHM).
- Developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO),
- The Indian Army successfully concluded 'Op Netra 1.0,' a four-day high-altitude mega eye camp in Leh, Ladakh, which provided advanced surgical care to 950 patients.
- In response to the Pahalgam terror attack on April 22, last year, in which 26 people, mostly tourists, were killed, India launched Operation Sindoor on May 7, carrying out airstrikes on nine terror infrastructures in Pakistan and Pakistan occupied Kashmir.
- The Indian Navy's Kilo-class submarine, INS Sindhukesari, recently arrived in Colombo for an Operational Turnaround (OTR).
- India recently issued a Notice to Airmen (NOTAM) designating a vast stretch of the Bay of Bengal as a danger zone for a long-range missile test.
- Hyderabad-based Skyroot Aerospace announced that it had become India's first space-tech unicorn following its latest round of funding of nearly USD 60 million, taking its valuation to USD 1.1 billion.
- South Korea launched its domestically developed Earth-observation satellite Compact Advanced Satellite 500-2 (CAS500-2) into orbit.
- Recently, in a major defence-tech breakthrough, Hyderabad based company has developed India's first germanium-free thermal imaging payload for drones.
- The Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) has developed a priority pathogen list for syndromic surveillance in India.
- Artificial intelligence lab Anthropic touted a new feature for its Claude AI, which it calls "dreaming."
- NITI Aayog has proposed new standards for tyre pyrolysis oil and recovered carbon black, two products obtained from the thermal decomposition of waste tyres in the absence of oxygen.
- The Andhra Pradesh Forest Department, in collaboration with the Eastern Ghats Wildlife Society, has initiated a conservation status survey of the Peacock Tarantula (*Poecilotheria metallica*) in the vast landscape of the Nagarjunasagar Srisailem Tiger Reserve (NSTR).
- A tigress and her last surviving cub recently died at the Mukki quarantine facility in Madhya Pradesh's Kanha Tiger Reserve following a suspected outbreak of Canine Distemper Virus (CDV).
- New research indicates the Atlantic Meridional Overturning Circulation (AMOC) could weaken by up to 59% by 2100, far more severely than previous estimates of 15%.
- Recently, officials have confirmed the return of the rare caracal in the Thar Desert near the India-Pakistan border. IUCN: Least Concern
- The Tadoba-Andhari Tiger Reserve (TATR) in Maharashtra's Chandrapur district unveiled vibrant wildlife statistics during its annual 'Machan Census on Waterholes'
- Mount Dukono in eastern Indonesia erupted recently, sending an ash column up to 1,400 meters above its summit.
- Bengaluru has been ranked the world's fastest-growing major city through 2035 in Savills' Growth Hubs Index, which is part of the firm's Resilient Cities research programme.
- Recently, a high-level bilateral meeting between the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, Government of India, and the Ministry of Ethnic and Religious Affairs, Government of the Socialist Republic of Vietnam, was convened.
- European missile and related systems giant MBDA has signed an agreement with the Indian Air Force for the development of a local capability for the Maintenance, Repair, and Mid-Life Overhaul (MRO) of MICA Missiles.

- Strengthening ties between India and the Caribbean, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar handed over 10 Bharat Health Initiative for Sahyog Hita & Maitri (BHISHM) Cubes to Jamaica.
- Nepal has officially objected to the India-China plan to conduct the Kailash Mansarovar Yatra via the Lipulekh Pass, claiming the route violates its sovereignty.
- India's inclusion in the United States Trade Representative (USTR) Priority Watch List in 2026 has renewed focus on global concerns over intellectual property (IP) protection.
- Madame Tussauds launched a new "Icons of India" celebration at its London headquarters this week, uniting the wax models of celebrities from the world of cinema and cricket.
- A microbial ecosystem containing bacteria, archaea and DNA was found two metres below the surface of Chile's Atacama Desert.
- India has retained its position at the top of the ICC Men's T20I rankings, showcasing their dominance in the cricketing world.
- India has signed a participation agreement with FIFA for the inaugural FIFA ASEAN Cup, which is scheduled for the international window from 21 September to 6 October 2026.
- Delhi will host the Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026 at the Thyagraj Stadium, with players from more than 35 countries expected to participate.
- Jammu and Kashmir has achieved a historic milestone in table tennis as Ritvik Gupta clinched the Under-17 Boys National title at the UTT 87th Inter-State Junior and Youth National Table Tennis Championships, organised under the aegis of the Table Tennis Federation of India.
- The 34th edition of the Thomas Cup – the men's team world championships in badminton and the 31st Uber Cup – the women's variant was held in Horsens, Denmark. The finals were played on 3rd May.
- Seven-year-old swimmer Ishank from Ranchi has achieved a rare feat by crossing a challenging sea route between Sri Lanka and India, setting a new world record at a very young age.
- Indian pole vaulter Kuldeep Kumar rewrote the men's national record after recording 5.41m mark at the inaugural Indian Indoor Open Combined Events and Pole Vault Competition in Bhubaneswar.
- The Department of Financial Services (DFS) convened a colloquium of Chairpersons of Debt Recovery Appellate Tribunals and Presiding Officers of Debt Recovery Tribunals (DRTs) in New Delhi.

#### QUESTION OF THE DAY

**Hazaribag has been notified as India's first:**

हज़ारीबाग को भारत के पहले के रूप में अधिसूचित किया गया है:

- (a) Marine fisheries cluster
- (b) Pearl farming cluster
- (c) Inland salt production hub
- (d) Aquaculture export zone